01 · Platform Orientation

> *Audience: everyone · Time: 20 minutes · Prerequisite: none*

Learning objectives

By the end of this module you can log in, navigate by permission-aware menu, explain the portfolio hierarchy, and find any record in four clicks or fewer.

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1. What the platform is

PM Control Tower is a single enterprise system for managing the full delivery lifecycle:

```
PORTFOLIO  →  PROGRAM  →  PROJECT  →  WBS  →  TASKS  →  SCHEDULE
     ↑                                                      ↓
 BUDGETS / INVESTMENT          EVM · HEALTH · RAID · CHANGES · GATES
     ↑                                                      ↓
 LEADERSHIP REPORTING  ←  GOVERNANCE  ←  FINANCIALS  ←  ACTUALS/TIMESHEETS
```

Everything on a dashboard originates from operational records entered by the team — there are no "manual" dashboard numbers.

2. Logging in

1. Open `http://localhost:3000` (or the deployed URL).
2. Enter your email and password. Seeded demo accounts (password `Pmct@2026`):

Email	Person	Role
`ceo@pmct.io`	Alexandra Chen	Executive
`pmo@pmct.io`	Jordan Blake	PMO Administrator (super admin)
`portfolio@pmct.io`	Priya Nair	Portfolio Manager
`program@pmct.io`	Marcus Webb	Program Manager
`pm.sarah@pmct.io`	Sarah Okafor	Project Manager
`pm.david@pmct.io`	David Kim	Project Manager
`finance@pmct.io`	Elena Rodriguez	Finance Controller
`auditor@pmct.io`	Thomas Reed	Auditor
`liam@pmct.io` … `mia@pmct.io`	Liam, Ava, Noah, Mia	Team Members

3. Your **home screen is chosen by your permissions** — executives land on the Executive Control Tower, delivery roles land on their Work Inbox, read-only roles land on Reports. You always start where you can act.

3. The screen anatomy

- **Top bar** — global search (`⌘K` / `Ctrl+K` searches projects, tasks, risks, docs and people), quick-create (`+`), notifications, help, avatar menu.
- **Left navigation** — grouped by lifecycle phase; items appear only if your role holds the required permission. A greyed-out world does not exist: if you cannot see it, your role is not meant to use it.
- **Content area** — every list supports filters, every form validates inline, every drawer saves without leaving the page.
- **Live badges** — green "Live · HH:MM" chips show when data was last generated; the platform updates dashboards in real time as teammates act.

4. Navigation groups (what lives where)

Group	Purpose	Key screens
Executive	Portfolio command center	Executive Control Tower
Portfolio	Strategy hierarchy	Portfolios, Programs, Projects
Plan	Build the plan	Register, Requirements, WBS, Tasks, Agile, Schedule, Milestones, Baselines, Planning Lab
Execute	Run the work	Boards, Resources, Timesheets, Work Inbox, Focus Planner
Control	Performance & governance	Financials, Clients, Field Ops, Investment, EVM, Health, RAID, Changes, Gates, Governance, Integrity, CTO Tower, Prioritization
Strategy & Knowledge	Collective intelligence	Feedback & Roadmap, Docs, Message Boards, Proofing
Intelligence	Reporting & AI	Leadership Tower, Reports, Reporting Center, Analytics, AI Assistant
Connect	Automation & integrations	Integration Hub, Automations, Notifications, Webhooks, AI Gateway, Extensions
Administration	Platform control	Users, Roles, Templates, Audit Trail, Control Center, Configuration, Field Dictionary, Form Tab Builder

5. The vocabulary (memorise these seven words)

Term	Meaning
Baseline	The approved snapshot of scope, schedule and cost — the yardstick for variance.
EVM	Earned Value Management — integrates scope, schedule and cost into CPI/SPI indices.
RAG	Red/Amber/Green health status of a project.
RAID	Risks, Assumptions, Issues, Dependencies — the exposure register.
Stage Gate	A governance checkpoint where a board decides: pass, hold, or fail.
Change Request (CR)	A governed proposal to alter scope/schedule/cost with impact analysis.
Integrity / Freshness	A 0–100 score telling you how current a project's feeds are.

6. Hands-on exercise (5 min)

1. Log in as `pm.sarah@pmct.io` (Project Manager). Note your home screen.
2. Find **Planning Lab** in the menu; note which groups you *cannot* see.
3. Log out, log in as `ceo@pmct.io`. Compare the menu — which items appeared? Which disappeared?
4. Press `⌘K`, type `FLOW`, and open the PRJ-CZR-FLOW project from search.

Discussion: why does the platform hide screens instead of disabling buttons?
(Answer: least-privilege — the menu itself is the first line of access control, backed by server-side permission checks on every API call.)

7. Key takeaways

- Your role decides your home screen **and** your menu — the product adapts to you.
- Global search (`⌘K`) is the fastest path to any record.
- Learn the seven vocabulary words; every module in this curriculum builds on them.